Problem Statements

1. EdTech:

   Context-Aware Collaborative Learning Breakdown

   Students often take unstructured, context-dependent notes during fast-paced lectures, which become difficult to understand over time. This leads to inefficient revision, where learners spend more time re-learning than reinforcing concepts. At the same time, peer learning remains underutilized due to social hesitation, lack of suitable partners, and absence of structured collaboration systems.

   The disconnect between individual note-taking and collaborative learning results in poor knowledge retention, reduced engagement, and increased academic stress. A unified approach that bridges personal understanding with peer interaction is currently missing.

2. FinTech:

   Retirement Blindness Among Gen Z

   Students often struggle to plan for retirement due to its distant and abstract nature, leading them to prioritize immediate financial needs and lifestyle goals instead. Limited financial literacy and awareness further contribute to this issue, making it difficult for Gen Z to understand the importance of early investing and long-term financial planning. As a result, retirement planning is often delayed or ignored altogether.

   This lack of early action can have serious long-term consequences, including insufficient savings and financial insecurity in later life. The gap between awareness and action highlights the need for solutions that make retirement planning more engaging, relatable, and accessible, helping young individuals build consistent financial habits and ensure a more secure future.

3. RetailTech:

   DealDrop: Hyperlocal Flash Sale Platform

Local retailers often face challenges in clearing overstocked or near-expiry inventory due to limited digital presence and visibility. At the same time, nearby customers remain unaware of these time-sensitive deals, missing out on potential savings. The lack of effective discovery platforms further widens the gap between supply and demand at a hyperlocal level.

This disconnect results in lost revenue opportunities for retailers and reduced access to affordable products for customers. The absence of a system that enables real-time, location-based deal discovery highlights the need for a solution that connects local businesses with nearby consumers in a timely and efficient manner.

4. EcoTech:

   FoodBridge: Real-Time Surplus Food Redistribution Platform

   A significant amount of food waste occurs at the consumer level due to the absence of efficient redistribution systems. Surplus food often goes unused because there is no real-time mechanism to connect individuals or providers with those who need it. Additionally, limited awareness and poor coordination further hinder timely redistribution.

   This gap leads to increased food wastage, contributing to environmental damage and lost opportunities to combat hunger. Without a reliable and trusted system to manage logistics, safety, and accessibility, surplus food cannot be effectively utilized to support communities in need.

Rules and Regulations

1. Kickoff Ceremony:
   - Date: 28/03/2026
   - Time: 9:00 AM
   - Venue: IIITDM Kancheepuram

2. Hackathon Duration:
   - The hackathon will be a **36-hour** event.

- Teams can work in the provided hall during the specified hours or continue remotely.

3. Final Submission:
   - Date: 29/03/2026
   - Time: 9:00 PM
   - All teams must submit their projects strictly before the deadline.
   - Only team leader should submit the project.
   - **The submissions must be made online in a Google Form that will be shared on 29th March.**

Submission Guidelines

1. Project Submission:
   - **Teams must submit their project repository (via GitHub) and a 2-5 minute demo video**. The demo must be added to the project repository.
   - All submissions must occur before the deadline.

2. Code Requirements:
   - **The project must be developed during the duration of the hackathon.**
   - Teams can use open-source libraries and APIs, but must disclose them.

3. Documentation:
   - A **README** file must accompany the project explaining the problem statement, the solution, and the setup instructions.
   - **Only teams that attend at least one day in person with a valid fest pass are eligible for submission.**

Terms and Conditions

1. Ownership:
   - Teams retain ownership of their projects. However, hackathon organizers can request permission to present the projects in promotional materials.
2. Disqualification:
   - Any team found to be violating the rules or engaging in misconduct will be disqualified.
3. Liability:
   - Organizers are not responsible for technical failures or equipment problems during the event.

Evaluation Criteria

Each track will be judged based on the following parameters:

1. Innovation (20%)
   - Originality and creativity of the idea
   - Novel approach to solving the problem
   - Distinctiveness compared to existing solutions

2. Technical Implementation (35%)
   - Depth and complexity of the solution
   - Code quality, structure, and robustness
   - Handling of edge cases and overall system design

3. Feasibility (20%)
   - Practicality of the solution in real-world scenarios
   - Scalability and reliability

- Consideration of constraints such as performance and usability
- Scope for future development

4. Video Presentation (15%)
   - Clear and structured demonstration of the project
   - Explanation of the problem and solution
   - Effective showcasing of key features and functionality

5. Deployment / Hosting (10%)
   - Deployment / Hosting is mandatory in an accessible form.
   - Web Apps: Must be hosted and accessible via a public link
   - Mobile Apps: Must be provided in an installable and testable format (APK / TestFlight / emulator-friendly build)
   - Marks will be awarded based on the quality and completeness of deployment.
   - Accessibility of the project (e.g., usable by judges without setup)
   - Stability and proper functioning of the solution
   - Overall effort in making the project usable in a real-world setting

Additional Notes

- Incomplete or non-functional projects may be penalized
- Fake or non-working demos will lead to disqualification
- Additional credit may be given for real-world applicability and meaningful use of data

ALL THE BEST!